

ServiceNow Project Documentation: Implement Client Script & UI Policy (Incident)

This comprehensive project document provides end-to-end technical documentation for implementing client-side logic, data validation, and UI behavior policies on the Incident table in ServiceNow. The configurations documented herein ensure data integrity, streamline user experience, and enforce business rules both on Incident forms and list views.

Project Overview & Scope

The objective of this project is to implement dynamic client-side controls on the Incident (incident) table in ServiceNow. By leveraging UI Policies, UI Policy Actions, and Client Scripts (onChange, onSubmit, and onCellEdit), the platform enforces automated field behavior, field dependencies, form validations, and list editing security.

Milestone	Artifact Type	Artifact Name	Execution Context / Trigger
Milestone 1	UI Policy	High Impact Control	Triggers when Impact = 1 - High on Incident form
Milestone 2	UI Policy Action	Urgency Field Policy	Sets Urgency to Read-only when High Impact Control is active
Milestone 3	onChange Client Script	Auto set urgency for high impact	Fires when Impact field value changes on Incident form
Milestone 4	onSubmit Client Script	Prevent save if Assigned To missing	Fires on form submission to validate mandatory field 'Assigned To'
Milestone 5	onCellEdit Client Script	Prevent state change via list edit	Fires when user attempts to inline-edit the State column in Incident list
Milestone 6	Functional Testing	End-to-End Test Suite	Validation of 5 operational scenarios

Milestone	Artifact Type	Artifact Name	Execution Context / Trigger
			across UI Policies and Scripts

System Prerequisites & Environment Setup

- **ServiceNow Platform:** Personal Developer Instance (PDI) running Vancouver / Washington DC release.
- **User Roles Required:** admin or personal_dev_instance admin privileges to configure System UI elements.
- **Target Module:** Incident Management (incident table).
- **Navigation Paths:**
 - UI Policies: System UI > UI Policies
 - Client Scripts: System UI > Client Scripts
 - Incident List/Form: Incident > Create New / Incident > All

Milestone 1: Create UI Policy on Incident

UI Policies allow dynamically changing the behavior of information on a form based on conditions without scripting. In this step, a UI Policy named **High Impact Control** is created to govern field attributes when an incident is marked as High Impact.

Configuration Steps:

1. Navigate to System UI > UI Policies.
2. Click **New** to initiate a UI Policy record.
3. Configure the policy parameters:
 - **Name:** High Impact Control
 - **Table:** Incident [incident]
 - **Active:** true (Checked)
 - **Reverse if false:** true (Checked)
4. Set Condition: Impact is 1 - High.
5. Save the UI Policy record.
6. In the **UI Policy Actions** related list, click **New** to add an action for **Assignment group**:
 - **Field name:** Assignment group
 - **Mandatory:** True
7. Click **Submit**.

servicenow All Favorites History Workspaces **UI Policy - High Impact Control** Search

UI Policy High Impact Control

UI policies change fields on a form based on a set of conditions. Use UI policies to show or hide fields, or to make fields mandatory or read-only based on these conditions. A UI policy specifies one or more actions to take when the policy is triggered. First, create the policy. Then add as many actions as necessary. UI policy actions are applied only if all of the following conditions are met:

- The UI Policy is Active
- The items in the Conditions field evaluate to true
- The field specified in the UI policy action is present on the specified form

[More info](#)

Table: Incident [incident] Application: Global Active: ☒

* Short description: High Impact Control Order: 100

When to Apply

Conditions: [Add Filter Condition](#) [Add OR Clause](#)

Impact is 1 - High AND OR

Reverse if false: ☒ Global: ☒ On load: ☒ Inherit: ☐

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UI Policy High Impact Control

Reverse if false: ☒ Global: ☒ On load: ☒ Inherit: ☐

[Update](#) [Delete](#)

Related Links

[Convert this to Data Policy](#)
[Advanced view](#)
[Run Point Scan](#)

UI Policy Actions (2) **UI Policy Related List Actions**

for text Search Actions on selected rows... [New](#)

UI policy = High Impact Control

Field name	Mandatory	Visible	Read only
urgency	Leave alone	Leave alone	True
assignment_group	True	Leave alone	False

1 to 2 of 2

Milestone 2: Create UI Policy Action - Urgency Field

To prevent users from manually altering the Urgency field once High Impact is selected, a second UI Policy Action is linked to the **High Impact Control** UI Policy to enforce Read-only status on the Urgency field.

Configuration Steps:

1. Open the High Impact Control UI Policy created in Milestone 1.

2. Scroll down to the **UI Policy Actions** related list and click **New**.
3. Fill in the Action details:
 - **Field name:** Urgency
 - **Read-only:** True
 - **Visible:** Leave as is
 - **Mandatory:** Leave as is
4. Click **Submit** to save the action.

The screenshot shows the ServiceNow 'UI Policy Action - urgency' configuration page. The browser address bar shows 'dev427333.service-now.com'. The page title is 'UI Policy Action - urgency'. Below the title bar, there's a description: 'UI policy actions specify exactly what actions to take on a specified field. The conditions specified in the UI policy determine when these actions are triggered. [More Info](#)'. The configuration fields are as follows:

- UI policy:** High Impact Control
- Table:** Incident [incident]
- * Field name:** Urgency
- Application:** Global
- Mandatory:** Leave alone
- Visible:** Leave alone
- Read only:** True
- Clear the field value:** ☐

At the bottom left, there are 'Update' and 'Delete' buttons.

Milestone 3: Create onChange Client Script

The onChange Client Script automatically updates the urgency field to 1 - High whenever the user updates the impact field to 1 - High on the Incident form, and displays an informational message to the user.

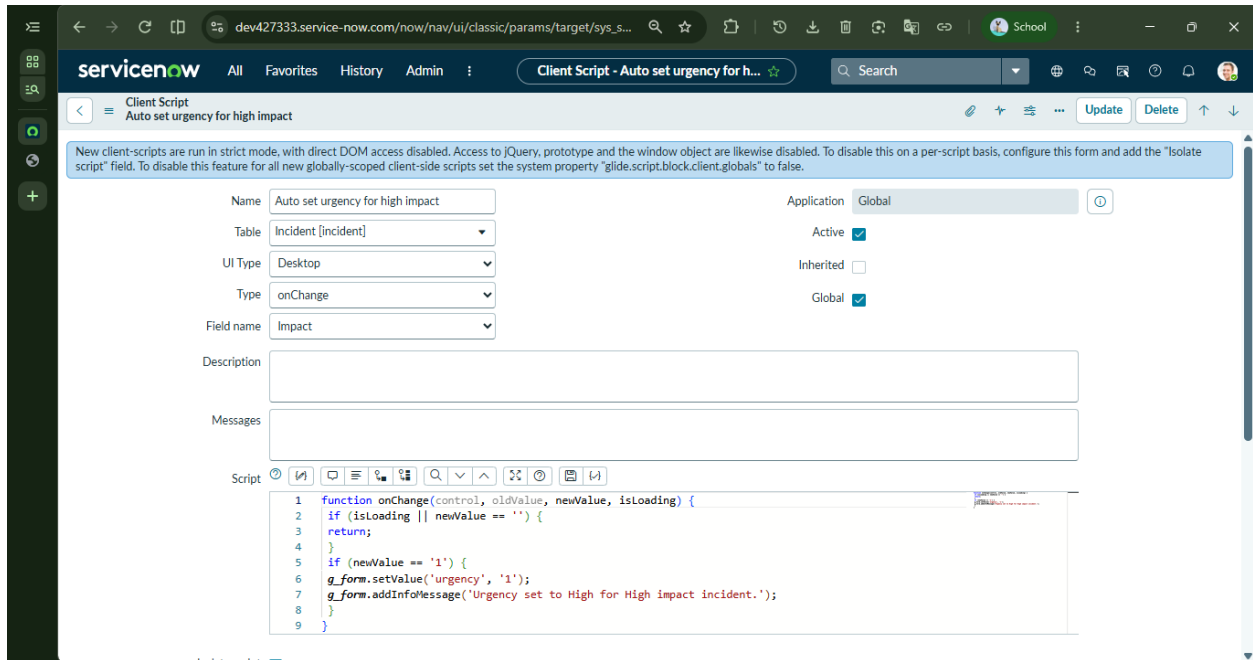
Setting	Configured Value
Name	Auto set urgency for high impact

Setting	Configured Value
Table	Incident [incident]
UI Type	All / Desktop
Type	onChange
Field name	Impact
Active	true

Script Implementation:

```
function onChange(control, oldValue, newValue, isLoading) {
    // Exit if the form is loading or the new value is empty
    if (isLoading || newValue == '') {
        return;
    }

    // Check if Impact is changed to '1' (High)
    if (newValue == '1') {
        g_form.setValue('urgency', '1');
        g_form.addInfoMessage('Urgency set to High for High impact incident.');
```



An onSubmit Client Script validates that high-impact incidents cannot be submitted without an assigned owner. If impact is set to 1 - High and assigned_to is empty, form submission is aborted and an error box is rendered under the field.

Setting	Configured Value
Name	Prevent save if Assigned To missing
Table	Incident [incident]
Type	onSubmit
Active	true

Script Implementation:

```
function onSubmit() {
    // Check if Impact is High ('1') and Assigned To is empty
    if (g_form.getValue('impact') == '1' && g_form.getValue('assigned_to') == '') {
```

```

        g_form.showErrorBox('assigned_to', 'Assigned To is mandatory for High
impact incidents.');
```

```

        return false; // Prevent form save
    }
    return true; // Allow form save
}
```

The screenshot shows the ServiceNow interface for configuring a Client Script. The breadcrumb trail is "Client Script - Prevent save if Assigned To missing". A notification bar at the top states: "New client-scripts are run in strict mode, with direct DOM access disabled. Access to JQuery, prototype and the window object are likewise disabled. To disable this on a per-script basis, configure this form and add the 'Isolate script' field. To disable this feature for all new globally-scoped client-side scripts set the system property 'glide.script.block.client.globals' to false."

The configuration form includes the following fields:

- Name:** Prevent save if Assigned To missing
- Table:** Incident [incident]
- UI Type:** Desktop
- Type:** onSubmit
- Application:** Global
- Active:** ☒
- Inherited:** ☐
- Global:** ☒
- Description:** (empty text area)
- Messages:** (empty text area)
- Script:**

```

1 function onSubmit() {
2   if (g_form.getValue('impact') == '1' &&
3       g_form.getValue('assigned_to') == '') {
4     g_form.showErrorBox(
5       'assigned_to',
6       'Assigned To is mandatory for High impact incidents.'
7     );
8     return false;
9   }
10  return true;
11 }
```
- Isolate script:** ☒

At the bottom of the form are "Update" and "Delete" buttons.

Milestone 5: Create onCellEdit Client Script

To prevent operational process bypasses, an onCellEdit Client Script is created to block users from modifying the State field directly from the Incident list view, forcing them to open the Incident record form.

Setting	Configured Value
Name	Prevent state change via list edit
Table	Incident [incident]

Setting	Configured Value
Type	onCellEdit
Field name	State
Active	true

Script Implementation:

```
function onCellEdit(sysIDs, table, oldValues, newValue, callback) {
    // Show alert informing user that list editing State is disabled
    alert('State cannot be updated using list editing. Please open the Incident.');
```

```
    // Pass false to callback to cancel the cell edit operation
    callback(false);
}
```

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[Favorites](#)
[History](#)
[Admin](#)

Client Script - Prevent state change via list edit

Search

Client Script

Prevent state change via list edit

Update Delete

New client-scripts are run in strict mode, with direct DOM access disabled. Access to jQuery, prototype and the window object are likewise disabled. To disable this on a per-script basis, configure this form and add the "Isolate script" field. To disable this feature for all new globally-scoped client-side scripts set the system property "glide.script.block.client.globals" to false.

Name

Prevent state change via list edit

Application

Global

Table

Incident [incident]

Active

☒

UI Type

Desktop

Inherited

☐

Type

onCellEdit

Global

☒

Field name

State

Description

Messages

Script

```

1 function onCellEdit(sysIDs, table, oldValues, newValue, callback) {
2     alert('State cannot be updated using list editing. Please open the Incident.');
```

```

3     callback(false);
4 }

```

Isolate script

☒

Update

Delete

Related Links

Milestone 6: Testing & Validation Results

Activity 1: Test Mandatory Enforcement (onSubmit Error Box)

Procedure: Create a new Incident record, set Impact to 1 - High, leave Assigned To blank, and click Submit.

Expected Result: Record save is blocked. An inline red error box appears under 'Assigned To' stating: *"Assigned To is mandatory for High impact incidents."*

The screenshot displays the ServiceNow 'Incident - Create INC0010009' form. The form is divided into two main sections: 'Incident' and 'Assignment'. The 'Incident' section includes fields for Number (INC0010009), Caller (Abel Tuter), Category (Inquiry / Help), Subcategory (-- None --), Service, Service offering, and Configuration item. The 'Assignment' section includes fields for Channel (-- None --), State (New), Impact (1 - High), Urgency (1 - High), Priority (1 - Critical), Assignment group (CAB Approval), and Assigned to. A red error box is visible under the 'Assigned to' field, stating: "Assigned To is mandatory for High impact incidents." Below the form, there is a 'Related Search Results' section with a search bar containing 'Test1' and a dropdown menu set to 'Knowledge & Catalog (All)'. The search results show 'No matching results found for Test1'.

Activity 2: Test Successful Save

Procedure: Populate Assigned To with a user (e.g., Beth Anglin) while Impact is 1 - High, and click Submit.

Expected Result: Record saves successfully. Urgency is set to 1 - High and becomes Read-only. Information banner states: *"Urgency set to High for High impact incident."*

servicenow All Favorites History Workspaces Admin Incident - INC0010009 Search

Incident INC0010009 Discuss Follow Update Resolve Delete Responses

Number INC0010009 Channel -- None --

* Caller Abel Tuter State In Progress

Category Inquiry / Help Impact 1 - High

Subcategory -- None -- Urgency 1 - High

Service Priority 1 - Critical

Service offering * Assignment group CAB Approval

Configuration item Assigned to Bernard Laboy

* Short description Test1

Description

Related Search Results >

Notes Related Records Resolution Information

Watch list Work notes list

Work notes

Comments (Customer visible) Post

Activities: 1 System Administrator

Field changes • 2026-09-25 12:04:32

Activity 3: Reverse Condition Test

Procedure: Open an existing High Impact incident and change Impact from 1 - High to 2 - Medium.

Expected Result: The UI Policy conditions invert: Assignment Group is no longer mandatory, and Urgency becomes editable again. Record saves without error.

servicenow All Favorites History Workspaces Admin Incident - INC0010009 Search

Incident INC0010009 Discuss Follow Update Resolve Delete Responses

Number INC0010009 Channel -- None --

* Caller Abel Tuter State In Progress

Category Inquiry / Help Impact 2 - Medium

Subcategory -- None -- Urgency 1 - High

Service Priority 2 - High

Service offering Assignment group CAB Approval

Configuration item Assigned to

* Short description Test1

Description

Related Search Results >

Notes Related Records Resolution Information

Watch list Work notes list

Work notes

Comments (Customer visible) Post

Activities: 3 System Administrator

Field changes • 2026-09-25 12:05:56

Activity 4: Test List Edit Blocking

Procedure: Navigate to Incident > All list view and double-click the State column cell for any record.

Expected Result: Browser alert pops up: *"State cannot be updated using list editing. Please open the Incident."* Cell modification is rejected.

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AllFavoritesHistoryWorkspacesAdmin

Incidents

Incidents

Updated

Search

Actions on selected rows...

New

	Number	Opened	Short description	Caller	Priority	State	Category	Assignment group	Assigned to	Updated	Updated by
	INC0010009	2026-09-25 12:03:09	Test1	Abel Tuter	2 - High	In Progress		CAB Approval	(empty)	2026-09-25 12:05:55	admin
	INC0008111	2019-07-22 14:04:57	ATF : Test1	System Administrator	4 - Low	In Progress	Inquiry / Help	(empty)	(empty)	2026-09-25 11:32:34	admin
	INC0010007	2026-09-25 11:16:53	Test1	Abel Tuter	2 - High	In Progress	Inquiry / Help	CAB Approval	(empty)	2026-09-25 11:24:51	admin
	INC0010003	2026-09-21 10:52:49	Hii	Abel Tuter	1 - Critical	In Progress	Inquiry / Help	CAB Approval	Bernard Laboy	2026-09-25 10:54:13	system
	INC0010002	2026-09-21 10:41:01	testing UI policy	Adela Cervantsz	1 - Critical	In Progress	Inquiry / Help	Software	Beth Anglin	2026-09-25 10:44:27	system
	INC0000601	2026-04-25 02:42:59	The USB port on my PC stopped working	Beth Anglin	4 - Low	Closed	Hardware	(empty)	(empty)	2026-09-20 09:33:25	system
	INC0000005	2026-01-23 15:06:52	CPU load high for over 10 minutes	Alejandro Mascall	1 - Critical	Closed	Hardware	Hardware	Bud Richman	2026-04-30 01:41:56	system
	INC0009004	2018-09-01 06:13:30	Defect tracking tool is down.	David Miller	3 - Moderate	Closed	Software	(empty)	(empty)	2026-04-30 01:41:55	system
	INC0000014	2026-01-02 15:37:35	Missing my home directory	Bow Ruggeri	1 - Critical	Closed	Inquiry / Help	(empty)	Bud Richman	2026-04-30 01:41:55	system
	INC0009002	2018-09-16 05:49:23	My computer is not detecting the headphone device	David Miller	3 - Moderate	Closed	Hardware	(empty)	(empty)	2026-04-30 01:41:54	system
	INC0007001	2018-10-16 22:47:10	Employee payroll application server is down.	David Miller	1 - Critical	New	Hardware	Opspace	(empty)	2026-04-30 01:32:04	system
	INC0000010	2026-01-28 14:53:02	Need Oracle 10GR2 installed	Fred Luddy	4 - Low	Closed	Database	Database	Don Goodliffe	2026-04-29 13:16:35	admin
	INC0000004	2026-02-03 14:49:22	Forgot email password	Fred Luddy	1 - Critical	Closed	Inquiry / Help	Service Desk	Bud Richman	2026-04-29 13:16:24	admin

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servicenow All Favorites History Workspaces

dev427333.service-now.com says
State cannot be updated using list editing. Please open the Incident.

OK

Number	Opened	Short description	Assigned to	Priority	State	Category	Subcategory	Updated	Updated by
INC0010009	2026-09-25 12:03:09	Test1	Abel Tuter	2 - High	In Progress	CAB Approval	(empty)	2026-09-25 12:05:55	admin
INC0008111	2019-07-22 14:04:57	ATF : Test1	System Administrator	4 - Low	In Progress	Inquiry / Help	(empty)	2026-09-25 11:32:34	admin
INC0010007	2026-09-25 11:16:53	Test1	Abel Tuter	2 - High	In Progress	Inquiry / Help	CAB Approval	2026-09-25 11:24:51	admin
INC0010003	2026-09-21 10:52:49	Hii	Abel Tuter	1 - Critical	In Progress	Inquiry / Help	CAB Approval	2026-09-25 10:54:13	system
INC0010002	2026-09-21 10:41:01	testing UI policy	Adela Cervantsz	1 - Critical	In Progress	Inquiry / Help	Software	2026-09-25 10:44:27	system
INC0000601	2026-04-25 02:42:59	The USB port on my PC stopped working	Beth Anglin	4 - Low	Closed	Hardware	(empty)	2026-09-20 09:33:25	system
INC0000005	2026-01-23 15:06:52	CPU load high for over 10 minutes	Alejandro Mascall	1 - Critical	Closed	Hardware	Hardware	2026-04-30 01:41:56	system
INC0009004	2018-09-01 06:13:30	Defect tracking tool is down.	David Miller	3 - Moderate	Closed	Software	(empty)	2026-04-30 01:41:55	system
INC0000014	2026-01-02 15:37:35	Missing my home directory	Bow Ruggeri	1 - Critical	Closed	Inquiry / Help	(empty)	2026-04-30 01:41:55	system
INC0009002	2018-09-16 05:49:23	My computer is not detecting the headphone device	David Miller	3 - Moderate	Closed	Hardware	(empty)	2026-04-30 01:41:54	system
INC0007001	2018-10-16 22:47:10	Employee payroll application server is down.	David Miller	1 - Critical	New	Hardware	Openspace	2026-04-30 01:32:04	system
INC0000010	2026-01-28 14:53:02	Need Oracle 10GR2 installed	Fred Luddy	4 - Low	Closed	Database	Database	2026-04-29 13:16:35	admin
INC0000004	2026-02-03 14:49:22	Forgot email password	Fred Luddy	1 - Critical	Closed	Inquiry / Help	Service Desk	2026-04-29 13:16:24	admin

1 to 20 of 71

Activity 5: Test Form-Based Update

Procedure: Open the Incident record form directly, change the State field to In Progress, and click Update.

Expected Result: Form submission is successful, and the State updates properly in the database.

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AllFavoritesHistoryWorkspacesAdmin

Incident - INC0010009

Search

IncidentINC0010009

DiscussFollowUpdateResolveDeleteResponses

NumberINC0010009

Channel-- None --

* CallerAbel Tuter

StateNew

CategoryInquiry / Help

Impact2 - Medium

Subcategory-- None --

Urgency1 - High

Service

Priority2 - High

Service offering

Assignment groupCAB Approval

Configuration item

Assigned to

* Short descriptionTest1

Description

Related Search Results

NotesRelated RecordsResolution Information

Watch listWork notes list

Work notes

Comments (Customer visible)Post

Activities: 4System AdministratorField changes • 2026-09-25 12:15:36

servicenow

AllFavoritesHistoryWorkspacesAdmin

Incident - INC0010009

Search

IncidentINC0010009

DiscussFollowUpdateResolveDeleteResponses

NumberINC0010009

Channel-- None --

* CallerAbel Tuter

StateIn Progress

CategoryInquiry / Help

Impact2 - Medium

Subcategory-- None --

Urgency1 - High

Service

Priority2 - High

Service offering

Assignment groupCAB Approval

Configuration item

Assigned to

* Short descriptionTest1

Description

Related Search Results

NotesRelated RecordsResolution Information

Watch listWork notes list

Work notes

Comments (Customer visible)Post

Activities: 5System AdministratorField Changes • 2026-09-25 12:17:03

servicenow All Favorites History Workspaces Admin Incidents Search											
Incidents Updated Search Actions on selected rows... New											
All											
☐	Number	Opened	Short description	Caller	Priority	State	Category	Assignment group	Assigned to	Updated	Updated by
☐	INC0010009	2026-09-25 12:03:09	Test1	Abel Tuter	2 - High	In Progress	Inquiry / Help	CAB Approval	(empty)	2026-09-25 12:17:03	admin
☐	INC0008111	2019-07-22 14:04:57	ATF : Test1	System Administrator	4 - Low	In Progress	Inquiry / Help	CAB Approval	Bernard Laboy	2026-09-25 12:14:38	admin
☐	INC0010007	2026-09-25 11:16:53	Test1	Abel Tuter	2 - High	In Progress	Inquiry / Help	CAB Approval	(empty)	2026-09-25 11:24:51	admin
☐	INC0010003	2026-09-21 10:52:49	Hii	Abel Tuter	1 - Critical	In Progress	Inquiry / Help	CAB Approval	Bernard Laboy	2026-09-25 10:54:13	system
☐	INC0010002	2026-09-21 10:41:01	testing UI policy	Adela Cervantsz	1 - Critical	In Progress	Inquiry / Help	Software	Beth Anglin	2026-09-25 10:44:27	system
☐	INC0000601	2026-04-25 02:42:59	The USB port on my PC stopped working	Beth Anglin	4 - Low	Closed	Hardware	(empty)	(empty)	2026-09-20 09:33:25	system
☐	INC0000005	2026-01-23 15:06:52	CPU load high for over 10 minutes	Alejandro Mascall	1 - Critical	Closed	Hardware	Hardware	Bud Richman	2026-04-30 01:41:56	system
☐	INC0009004	2018-09-01 06:13:30	Defect tracking tool is down.	David Miller	3 - Moderate	Closed	Software	(empty)	(empty)	2026-04-30 01:41:55	system
☐	INC0000014	2026-01-02 15:37:35	Missing my home directory	Bow Ruggeri	1 - Critical	Closed	Inquiry / Help	(empty)	Bud Richman	2026-04-30 01:41:55	system
☐	INC0009002	2018-09-16 05:49:23	My computer is not detecting the headphone device	David Miller	3 - Moderate	Closed	Hardware	(empty)	(empty)	2026-04-30 01:41:54	system
☐	INC0007001	2018-10-16 22:47:10	Employee payroll application server is down.	David Miller	1 - Critical	New	Hardware	Openspace	(empty)	2026-04-30 01:32:04	system
☐	INC0000010	2026-01-28 14:53:02	Need Oracle 10GR2 installed	Fred Luddy	4 - Low	Closed	Database	Database	Don Goodliffe	2026-04-29 13:16:35	admin
☐	INC0000004	2026-02-03 14:49:22	Forgot email password	Fred Luddy	1 - Critical	Closed	Inquiry / Help	Service Desk	Bud Richman	2026-04-29 13:16:24	admin

Conclusion

All 6 milestones for the **Implement Client Script & UI Policy (Incident)** project have been configured, tested, and validated. The combination of UI Policies and Client Scripts ensures robust client-side validation, improves user workflow accuracy, and prevents erroneous data modifications across Incident form and list contexts.